

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager, higher-ed SaaS.*

Positioning, 13 years shipping B2B SaaS products in regulated industries, now bringing that discipline to Modern Campus.

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§ WHY MODERN CAMPUS

Modern Campus builds the operating system for higher education institutions, a domain where legacy workflows, compliance requirements, and diverse stakeholder groups make product work hard. The posting calls out AI-enabled product experience and analytics-driven decisions alongside a need to own a full backlog, which is exactly the combination I have been doing in regulated B2B SaaS contexts for the past several years. The customer segment, institutions managing student lifecycle and workforce outcomes, is one where user research and cross-functional alignment matter more than feature velocity. *That kind of complexity is where I do my best work.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair programming and test scaffolding
- **Cursor**, context-aware code navigation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes
- **GPT**, user story drafting and edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder deck production

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, Matomo, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, keeping acquisition cost near zero.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs the full day-to-day operation.
 - Proves end-to-end SaaS product thinking, discovery, build, and funnel analytics, relevant to any B2B platform role.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MODERN CAMPUS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Talk to customers, read support tickets, and sit in on customer success calls to understand where the product creates friction in actual higher-ed workflows.

WEEK 2

Map the backlog.

Audit the existing backlog against the KPIs already in place, flag the items with no clear success measure, and align with Engineering and UX on the top three near-term priorities.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Run the first sprint review with clear before/after metrics, establish a lightweight discovery cadence with two or three customer contacts per sprint, and push the first measurable outcome.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Modern Campus team,

I have spent 13 years working in B2B SaaS and regulated industries, insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare, where the stakeholders are demanding, the workflows are complex, and the margin for vague requirements is zero. The Product Manager role at Modern Campus is a natural fit for that background: higher education is a domain where institutions run on legacy processes, compliance is non-negotiable, and the value of a well-defined roadmap is immediately visible.

The posting highlights AI-enabled product experience and analytics-driven decisions alongside full backlog ownership. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an internal AI and Data platform for the FCAS European programme, leading a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists. I instrumented two competing workflows to resolve a strategic disagreement about UI-led versus developer-code-first design, the data settled it in two weeks. At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I reduced the time cost of each data update by 75% by introducing Dagster and dbt into the ETL pipeline and integrating test automation into Jenkins. Both examples are the kind of data-to-decision loop the role asks for.

On the AI side, I work with LLM agents and agentic workflows daily, not as a novelty but as a delivery tool. At construct8, my own B2B marketplace, I run LLM agents across the funnel so that one person handles what would otherwise require a small operations team. I also use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Lovable to prototype and specify features faster than a traditional discovery cycle allows. Evaluating AI and automation opportunities for a SaaS product is something I can contribute to from day one.

Stakeholder alignment across business, engineering, QA, and data teams is where I spend most of my time in any role. At EMIL Group I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams after it was losing senior engineers and client trust, attrition dropped from near-total to a single departure. At CLINET Platforms I cut a roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures and saw user acceptance rise more than fivefold. Both situations required clear communication, willingness to make unpopular calls, and consistent follow-through on what was promised.

I would welcome a conversation about where Modern Campus is taking its product and where my background would be most useful.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in B2B SaaS, regulated industries, and AI-enabled platforms, spanning insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, and healthcare. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user needs into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe). I define KPIs before we build and check them after we ship.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and Data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence; championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes.
- Redirected product strategy based on instrumented workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Defined and tracked KPIs across two competing workflows; the data resolved a strategic disagreement in two weeks.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving 75% of time per data update.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline; migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers, giving the team autonomous control of its environments.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows; digital anamnesis time dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL,
MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

- Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B SaaS procurement webshop. Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and 20,000 employees; backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019-12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - PRESENT

- Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace. Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise buyer requirements. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, operating inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision, product roadmap, prioritisation, backlog refinement, MVP definition, KPI definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, go-to-market support, product lifecycle management.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

SaaS and Agile Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, SQL.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, change management, conflict resolution.

Technical Environments: Python, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Kafka, MongoDB.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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